Emancipation Proclamation & Gettysburg Address

President Abraham Lincoln · 1863

Source: Lincoln, Emancipation Proclamation and Gettysburg Address (1863). Public domain. Continuous passages.

> Two turning points of 1863: the Proclamation reframed the war as a fight to end slavery and opened the army to Black soldiers, while at Gettysburg Lincoln redefined the war as a test of whether a nation "dedicated to the proposition that all men are created equal" could endure.

And by virtue of the power, and for the purpose aforesaid, I do order and declare that all persons held as slaves within said designated States, and parts of States, are, and henceforward shall be free; and that the Executive government of the United States, including the military and naval authorities thereof, will recognize and maintain the freedom of said persons.

[. . .]

It is rather for us to be here dedicated to the great task remaining before us — that from these honored dead we take increased devotion to that cause for which they gave the last full measure of devotion — that we here highly resolve that these dead shall not have died in vain, that this nation under God shall have a new birth of freedom, and that government of the people, by the people, for the people shall not perish from the earth.